SKILLNAVORA · AI TOOLS · ZAPIER TUTORIAL

Zapier: Complete Tutorial

Connect your apps without code: Zaps, triggers and actions, filters, paths, formatter, webhooks, AI steps, templates and a lead-handling project.

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How to use this guide

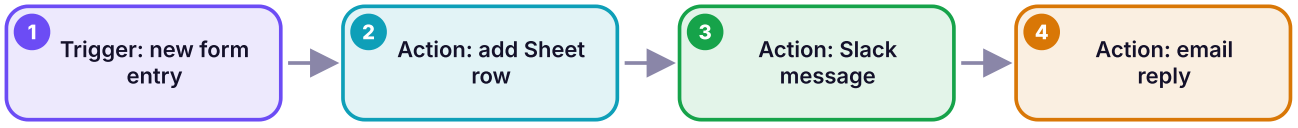
Each class has goals, concepts with Indian examples, key takeaways and a practice exercise, from basic to advanced. Finish with the final project to build something you can show in interviews.

	Class	Level
Class 1	**How Zapier works**	Basic
Class 2	**Build your first Zap: form → Sheet → Slack**	Basic
Class 3	**Logic: filters, paths, formatter, delay, lookup**	Intermediate
Class 4	**Webhooks, AI steps and Tables**	Intermediate
Class 5	**Template library: 6 Zaps to copy**	Intermediate
Class 6	**Project, costs, security and limits**	Advanced
	Toolkit: templates, zapier cheat sheet, glossary, 4 interview questions, further reading	

BASIC · CLASS 1

How Zapier works

Know the building blocks and the pricing logic.



A Zap = trigger + actions

- **Zap:** one automation. **Trigger:** the event that starts it. **Action:** each step after.
- **Task:** each successful action run counts toward your plan's monthly limit; triggers and filtered-out runs don't (check the current pricing page).
- **Connections:** sign in once per app (Google, Slack, Gmail, Typeform, HubSpot, Notion...).
- **Test steps:** every step has a test that pulls real sample data to map into later steps.

Sign up at zapier.com, open **Zaps → Create**, and look at the editor: trigger on top, actions below, a **Publish** switch.

Key takeaways

- Zap = trigger + actions.
- Tasks drive pricing.
- Always test each step.

Practice exercise: Sign up and list 5 things in your work that start with 'when X happens...'.

BASIC · CLASS 2

Build your first Zap: form → Sheet → Slack

Follow the steps to automate lead capture.

1. **Trigger:** choose **Google Forms** (or Typeform / Webflow) → **New Response** → connect account → pick the form → **Test trigger**.
2. **Action 1: Google Sheets → Create Spreadsheet Row**; pick the sheet; map each column (Name, Email, Phone) from the trigger data.
3. **Action 2: Slack → Send Channel Message**; text: `New lead: {Name} ({Email}, {Phone})`.
4. **Action 3 (optional): Gmail → Send Email** to the lead: "Thanks {Name}, we'll call you within 24 hours."
5. Test each step, then click **Publish**. Submit the form once to see it run in **Zap runs** (history).

Key takeaways

- Map fields from earlier steps.
- Test before publishing.
- Check Zap runs history.

Practice exercise: Build this Zap and run it with 3 test form entries.

INTERMEDIATE · CLASS 3

Logic: filters, paths, formatter, delay, lookup

Make Zaps smarter without code.

Tool	Use	Example
Filter	Continue only if...	Budget ≥ ₹50,000
Paths	Branches (if/else)	Hot lead → Slack + call; Cold lead → nurture email
Formatter	Clean text, dates, numbers	Capitalise names, format phone to +91...
Delay	Wait before the next step	Send follow-up after 2 days
Lookup / Find	Search before creating	Find contact by email; update, else create (no duplicates)
Looping	Handle many items	Create a row per order item

Key takeaways

- Filters stop, paths branch.
- Formatter cleans data.
- Look up before creating to avoid duplicates.

Practice exercise: Add a filter and a 2-path split to your lead Zap.

INTERMEDIATE · CLASS 4

Webhooks, AI steps and Tables

Connect any app and add AI.

- **Webhooks by Zapier:** *Catch Hook* gives you a URL; your website or Razorpay POSTs JSON to it; use the fields in later steps. *POST* action sends data out. Test with a webhook tester first.
- **AI steps:** add an AI/ChatGPT/Claude step ("Classify this lead as Hot/Warm/Cold and write a 2-line summary") then route on its answer.
- **Tables & Interfaces:** store records and build simple forms or approval pages (look for current names in your plan).
- **Reliability:** turn on **autoreplay**/error notifications; use Zap names and folders.

Key takeaways

- Catch Hook = custom trigger.
- AI step + path = smart routing.
- Turn on error alerts.

Practice exercise: Send a test webhook from webhook.site into a Zap and route on a field.

INTERMEDIATE · CLASS 5

Template library: 6 Zaps to copy

Reusable recipes for PMs and small teams.

Recipe	Trigger → Actions
Lead capture	Form → Sheet + Slack + welcome email
Meeting notes	Calendar event ends → Docs note → Slack summary
Feedback to roadmap	Typeform response → AI tag → Notion database
Payment receipt	Razorpay/Stripe payment → invoice email + Sheet row
Bug triage	Slack emoji reaction → Jira ticket
Weekly digest	Schedule (Mon 9:00) → Sheet data → AI summary → email

Key takeaways

- Start from a recipe, then adapt.
- Name steps clearly.
- Document each Zap's owner.

Practice exercise: Build two recipes and write a one-line owner note for each.

ADVANCED · CLASS 6

Project, costs, security and limits

Run Zapier reliably and affordably.

Project: lead desk

Website form → AI classification → Hot leads Slack + calendar link; all leads to Sheet; Day-2 follow-up; weekly summary. Add error alerts and an owner.

- **Cost:** count tasks per run × expected volume; merge steps; use filters early.
- **Security:** least-privilege app connections; don't send personal data you don't need (DPDP); remove old connections.
- **Limits:** rate limits and polling delay on free plans; use webhooks for instant triggers.

Key takeaways

- Filter early to save tasks.
- Alert on errors.
- Minimise personal data.

Practice exercise: Complete the lead desk project and calculate its monthly task cost.

TOOLKIT

Templates

Zapier project brief

Field	Fill in
Trigger	
Actions (in order)	
Filters / paths	
AI step	
Error alerts + owner	
Expected tasks per month	

TOOLKIT

Zapier cheat sheet

Term / tool	Meaning / use
Zap	One automation
Trigger / Action	Start event / each next step
Task	One successful action run (billing unit)
Filter / Paths	Stop / branch
Catch Hook	Webhook trigger URL
Formatter	Built-in data cleaning
Zap runs	Run history for debugging

Glossary

INTERVIEW PREP

4 interview questions with answers

Q1. What is Zapier?

A no-code tool that connects apps: a trigger in one app runs actions in others.

Q2. Trigger vs action?

Trigger starts the Zap when an event happens; actions are the steps that follow.

Q3. How do you avoid duplicate records?

Use a Find/Lookup step first, then update or create.

Q4. How would you connect a custom website?

Use Webhooks by Zapier's Catch Hook URL and POST JSON from your site.

LEARN MORE

Further reading and tools

- Zapier Learn: https://learn.zapier.com/
- Zapier Help Center: https://help.zapier.com/
- Zapier templates: https://zapier.com/templates
- Webhooks by Zapier: https://zapier.com/apps/webhook/integrations

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